

Gavin Jackson

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Staff / Principal Frontend Engineer

Frontend engineering leader with 20+ years' experience designing scalable web applications, engineering platforms and frontend architecture.

Technical leader through two successful company acquisitions and creator of **ICX**, a proprietary metadata-driven frontend application platform powering enterprise wealth management software.

Specialises in building engineering platforms, tooling and automation that enable teams to deliver complex software rapidly without accumulating technical debt.

Career Highlights

- Creator and Chief Architect of **ICX**, a metadata-driven frontend application platform that standardised development across 14 enterprise products and significantly accelerated product delivery.
- Led frontend engineering for wealth management platforms supporting clients managing over **£400 billion** in assets
- Delivered digital products for Nike, Disney, Intel, HP, Mattel and Estée Lauder
- Established a metadata-first architecture where applications, documentation, automated tests and developer tooling are all generated from a shared source of truth.

Core Skills

Leadership	Engineering	Frontend	UX
Frontend Architecture	Design Systems	JavaScript	Design & Animation
Technical Strategy	Component Libraries	HTML5	White Labelling
Engineering Leadership	Metadata-driven Architecture	CSS3 / LESS	Information Architecture
Team Leadership & Mentoring	Developer Experience	React / Vue / Svelte	Wireframing & Prototyping
Hiring & Technical Interviews	CI/CD	Web Components	Understanding & Estimating Requirements
Stakeholder Management	Code Reviews	Automated Testing with Cypress	Video Editing / Creation
Product Strategy	API Design & Data Structures	Responsive Design	Interaction design & Microinteractions
Agile Delivery	Git / Azure DevOps	Cross Browser	Accessibility
Technical Roadmaps	AI-assisted Development	Performance	Analytics

Professional Experience

Digital Keystone / Dunstan Thomas

Group Head of Frontend Engineering

2011 – Present

Leads frontend engineering across the company's flagship wealth management platform, defining architecture, engineering standards and long-term technical strategy, collaborating closely with backend engineers, solution architects and product leadership to deliver enterprise software.

Key Achievements

- Conceived, architected and built **ICX**, a proprietary **metadata-driven frontend application platform** used to deliver award-winning, enterprise wealth management software for organisations including **7IM** (£27 billion AUM), **Aegon** (£240 billion AUM), **Canada Life UK** (£39 billion AUM) and **Nucleus** (£100 billion AUM)
- Played a key technical leadership role during **two successful company acquisitions**
- Led frontend engineering across multiple product teams
- Mentored and developed **8** frontend engineers, establishing engineering standards, mentoring practices and a culture of technical excellence.
- Worked with senior leadership to define frontend strategy and long-term technical direction
- Introduced AI-assisted engineering workflows using GitHub Copilot, custom instruction files and code-generation techniques, improving developer productivity
- Supported pre-sales activities, technical demonstrations and enterprise customer engagements
- Expanded ICX into a complete engineering platform including:
 - Frontend application framework
 - Reusable component library
 - Shared metadata architecture
 - Living documentation platform
 - Visual regression testing platform
 - Accessibility framework
 - Build tooling and code generation

ICX — Creator & Chief Architect

Internal Frontend Developer Platform

Designed and built **ICX**, a proprietary metadata-driven frontend application platform that fundamentally changed how enterprise applications are developed within the organisation.

Rather than building each application independently, ICX enables complete enterprise applications to be assembled from metadata while retaining the flexibility for bespoke development where required.



Today ICX underpins **14** enterprise applications and has remained the foundation of frontend development across the organisation for more than a decade, continually evolving alongside product and engineering requirements.

Key capabilities include: Dynamic forms • Dashboard framework • Workflow engine • Validation engine • Theme engine • Responsive layouts • Reusable UI component library (**35+**) • Plugin architecture • Developer tooling • Build automation

Living Documentation Platform

Designed and built a living documentation platform inspired by the developer experience of Storybook, but extended so that documentation, live examples and automated tests are all generated from shared JSON manifests, ensuring documentation remains permanently synchronised with the implementation.

Features include: Automatic API documentation from component manifests • Embedded code examples • Markdown-authored guides and tutorials • Version-controlled documentation • Zero duplication between implementation and documentation • Feature usage tracking (during test runs) and reporting directly in the documentation

The platform became the primary reference for frontend engineers, significantly improving discoverability, onboarding and adoption of the shared component library. The documentation platform also serves as the foundation for automated testing, allowing every component, configuration variant and example to be continuously validated for visual, functional and accessibility regressions.

By treating documentation as metadata rather than static content, engineers always work from documentation that reflects the current implementation.

You can access the ICX documentation [here](#)

Automated Testing

Created a visual regression platform that tests application routes, generates interactive site maps, records feature usage and performs visual and accessibility regression testing across the entire application.

Reduced regression testing effort while increasing confidence in releases.

[An example site map and prototype app](#)

Accessibility

Defined accessibility standards, reusable components and development processes that embedded WCAG and ARIA compliance throughout the software development lifecycle, making accessible development the default rather than an afterthought.

Performance

Introduced benchmarking, profiling and bundle analysis to ensure applications remained responsive as the platform evolved while shipping only essential JavaScript to production.

Earlier Career — Agency & Consultancy

Before specialising in enterprise FinTech, delivered digital products for agencies and consultancies across the UK (and one in Australia), working with brands including Nike, Intel, Disney, Mattel, HP, Jo Malone, Estée Lauder and the Victorian Government.

Company	Type	Location	Dates
GDS International	Contract	Bristol	Feb 2011 – Mar 2011
Estée Lauder	Contract	Remote	Jul 2010 – Dec 2010
Oakwood DC	Contract	Bristol	2009 – 2010
Enable Interactive	Contract	Bristol	2009 – 2010
Bray Leino	Contract	Remote	2009
Oakwood DC	Permanent	Bristol	2007 – 2009
Publicis Mojo	Contract	Melbourne	2006
Sol-Tec	Permanent	Reading	2003 – 2005
Strudwick & Young	Permanent	Reading	2002 – 2003
ACS	Contract	High Wycombe	2000 – 2002

Open Source & Personal Projects

StravaDH

Designed and developed an online GPX processing [tool](#) that automatically detects uplift-assisted downhill mountain bike sessions and removes the uplift sections before uploading to Strava.

GuessWho DT Edition

Built a browser-based version of Guess Who during a one-day internal hackathon using existing avatars of Dunstan Thomas employees. You can play it [here](#)

Education

De Montfort University

BSc (Hons) Multimedia Computing — First Class

Graduated **top of the class**.

Interests

Outside work I enjoy mountain biking, road cycling and skiing, and regularly build personal software projects to explore new technologies. My latest project, StravaDH, combines mapping, GPX processing and frontend engineering to solve a real-world problem for downhill mountain bikers.